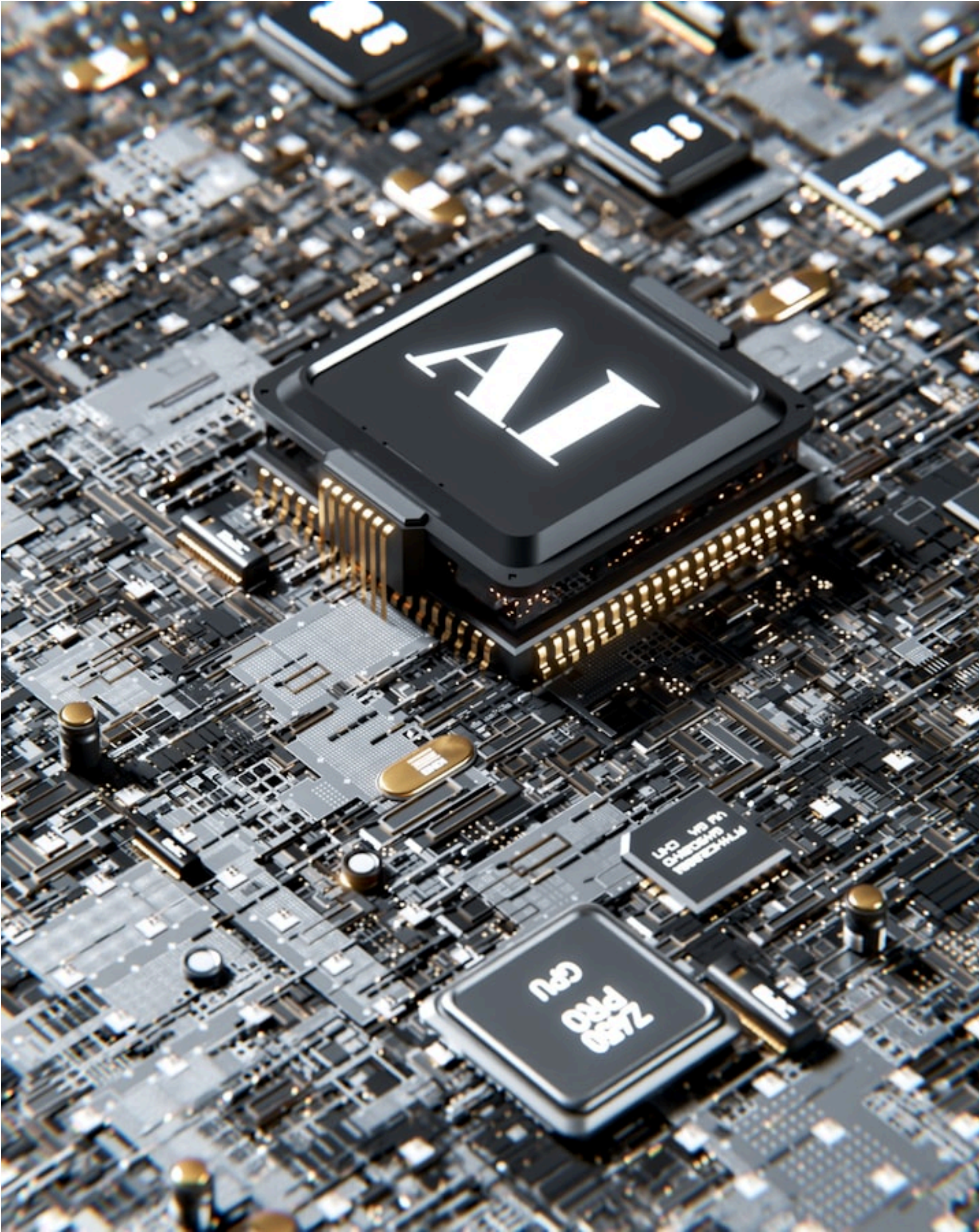


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On Air · Daniel

1편 수록

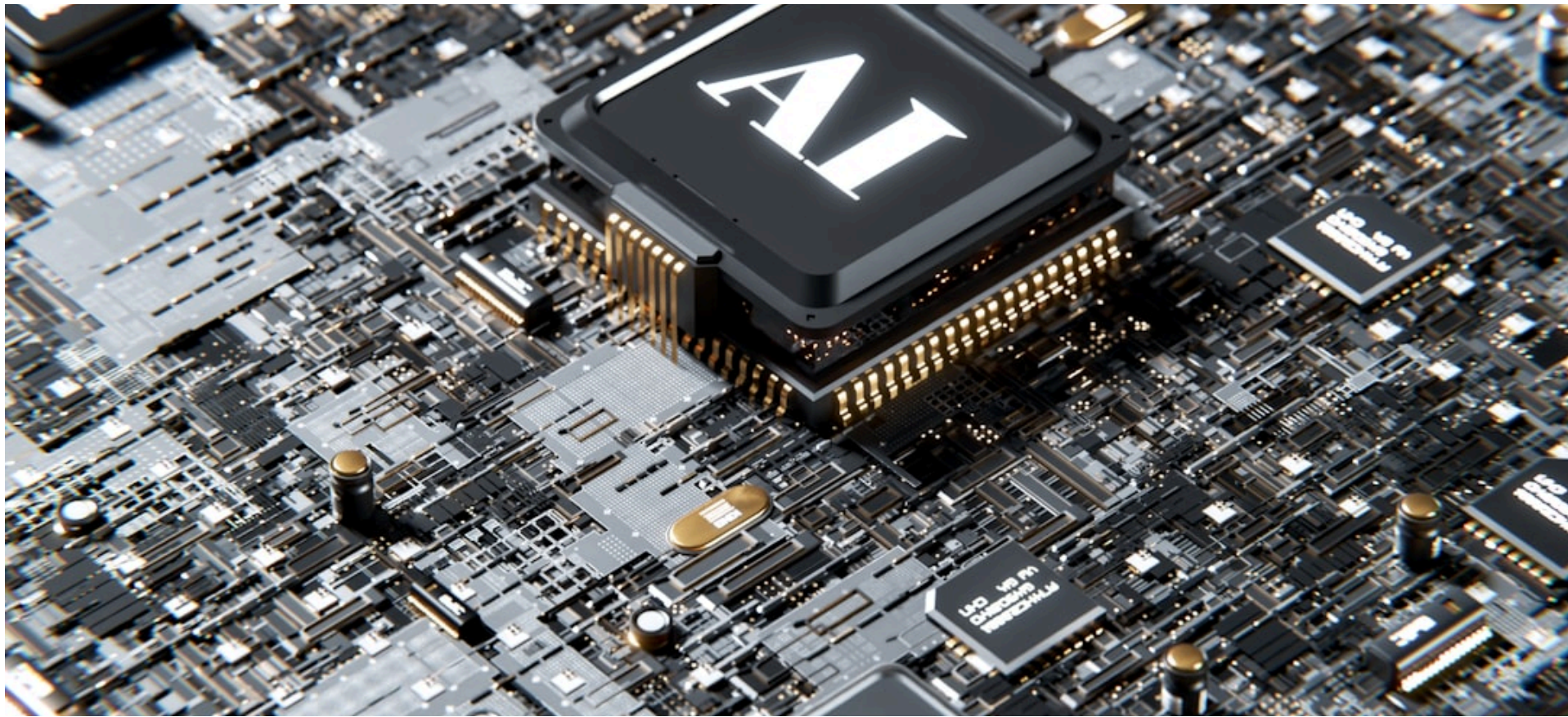


이번 호 기사

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The Race to Subsidize Semiconductors: Worth the Cost?

By Daniel · 2026-08-24 · 288 words · L3



반도체 보조금 경쟁의 득실

Governments around the world are spending billions of dollars to build domestic semiconductor industries. The United States, the European Union, Japan, and South Korea have all launched major subsidy programs in recent years, hoping to secure their own supply of chips.

Semiconductors are tiny electronic components that power everything from smartphones to military systems. Because so much of global chip production is concentrated in Taiwan and South Korea, many governments grew worried about supply chain risks — especially after chip shortages hit the auto and electronics industries hard during the COVID-19 pandemic.

The U.S. responded with the CHIPS and Science Act of 2022, committing roughly \$52 billion to support domestic chip manufacturing and research. Supporters say the law has already helped create over 120,000 jobs and encouraged major companies to invest in new factories on U.S. soil.

However, critics point to serious challenges. Funding has been slow to reach companies, and building advanced chip factories requires highly skilled engineers that many countries simply do not have enough of. Intel, which received significant U.S. government support, still ran into major financial difficulties.

Analysts also warn that competing with Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing

Company, known as TSMC, is extremely difficult. TSMC produces the most advanced chips in the world and benefits from decades of expertise and a deep local talent pool.

There are broader concerns as well. Some economists argue that large government subsidies can distort markets and lead to wasteful spending if political priorities drive funding decisions rather than economic ones.

Still, many governments see chip independence as a matter of national security, not just economics. Whether these costly programs will deliver lasting results remains an open question — and one that will shape the global technology landscape for decades.

한글 요약

코로나19 팬데믹 이후 반도체 공급망 리스크가 부각되면서 미국, EU, 일본 등 주요국들이 자국 반도체 산업 육성을 위한 대규모 보조금 프로그램을 경쟁적으로 추진하고 있다. 미국은 2022년 반도체·과학법을 통해 약 520억 달러를 투입하며 일자리 창출과 공장 건설을 유도하고 있으나, 자금 지원 지연과 전문 인력 부족 등 구조적 난관에 직면해 있다. 수십 년의 기술력과 인재풀을 갖춘 TSMC와의 경쟁이 현실적으로 쉽지 않은 데다, 일부 경제학자들은 정치적 논리에 의한 보조금 지원이 시장 왜곡과 재정 낭비를 초래할 수 있다고 경고한다. 각국 정부는 반도체 자립을 국가 안보의 문제로 간주하고 있으나, 이러한 대규모 투자가 장기적으로 실효성 있는 결실을 맺을 수 있을지는 여전히 불확실하다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

semiconductor 반도체
subsidy 보조금
domestic 국내의
supply chain 공급망

shortage 부족, 공급 부족
distort 왜곡하다
expertise 전문 지식, 전문성

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이름날짜학교 · 반

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